

Riyasat Ohib

CONTACT INFORMATION	Google DeepMind New York City, NY, USA riyasatohib.com riyasat.ohib@gmail.com	 GitHub  LinkedIn  Google Scholar
RESEARCH INTERESTS	I study how deep networks organize computation and meaning through the subnetworks, subspaces, and representations that arise during training. My research asks how such structure emerges, how it shapes learning and adaptation, and how it varies across architectures, tasks, and training settings. I am drawn to methods simple enough to analyze, cheap enough to deploy, and that tell you something true about how a model works.	
EDUCATION	PhD, Georgia Institute of Technology Electrical and Computer Engineering Concentration in Artificial Intelligence · GPA: 4.0/4.0 Dissertation: The Hidden Structure of Deep Models: Discovering and Exploiting Sparse Subnetworks Advisors: Vince D. Calhoun and Sergey Plis MS, Georgia Institute of Technology Electrical and Computer Engineering Concentration in Artificial Intelligence · GPA: 4.0/4.0 Thesis: Explicit Group Sparse Projection for Machine Learning	Aug 2021 – May 2026 Atlanta, GA Aug 2019 – Aug 2021 Atlanta, GA
EXPERIENCE	Google DeepMind , Research Scientist Permanent, full-time • Research on representations, control, alignment and interpretability of large-scale frontier models. Google DeepMind , Research Intern Model Alignment, Control, Responsibility and Safety • Studied how concepts are represented in the residual stream of diffusion transformers, and how that structure can be used to steer generation (CVPR, HOW 2026). Cohere , Intern of the Technical Staff LLM Efficiency Research • Developed inference-time activation sparsity methods for large language models, targeting deployment settings where latency and serving cost dominate. Dolby Laboratories , PhD Research Intern Experience Delivery Lab, Advanced Technologies Group • Designed a parameter-efficient fine-tuning method for LLMs based on probabilistic layer selection, concentrating updates on the layers most relevant to the downstream task. Meta AI (FAIR) , Research Scientist Intern Sparsity and Efficiency • Designed and implemented <i>WeiGit</i> , a git-like library for versioning and compressing neural network weights during training; released as part of facebookresearch/fairscale . • Studied extreme sparsity in deep networks using signal-processing transforms (FFT, DCT) applied during training.	Jul 2026 – Present New York City, NY Sep 2025 – May 2026 Kirkland, WA Sep 2024 – Dec 2024 Atlanta, GA May 2024 – Aug 2024 Atlanta, GA May 2022 – Aug 2022 Menlo Park, CA

EXPERIENCE
(continued)

TReNDS Center, Graduate Research Assistant
Georgia Institute of Technology

Aug 2019 – Aug 2026
Atlanta, GA

- Developed Grouped Sparse Projection, a projection-based algorithm for training sparse deep models that retains near-baseline accuracy above 90% sparsity (TMLR 2022; ICLR HAET workshop 2021).
- Developed communication-efficient federated learning methods for the non-IID regime, with applications to distributed neuroimaging (TMLR 2026; *Frontiers in Neuroinformatics* 2024).
- Developed single-shot pruning and neural-pathway discovery methods for offline and multi-task reinforcement learning, in collaboration with [Mila](#), Montreal (NeurIPS 2024).
- Introduced sparse adapters as parameter-efficient building blocks for modular architectures, outperforming LoRA and full fine-tuning when merged across up to 20 NLP tasks, in collaboration with Mila (COLM 2025).

PUBLICATIONS
* Equal contribution

- [1] **R. Ohib**, M. Hahn, M. Malek. *Concept Spaces in the Residual Stream of Diffusion Transformers*. IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR), HOW, 2026. [\[paper\]](#)
- [2] **R. Ohib**, B. Thapaliya, G. K. Dziugaite, J. Liu, V. D. Calhoun, S. Plis. *SSFL: Discovering Sparse Unified Subnetworks at Initialization for Efficient Federated Learning*. Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR), 2026. [\[paper\]](#)
- [3] J. Gammell, B. Thapaliya, Y. Jung, **R. Ohib**, B. Fehri, D. Chakrabarti. *Learning to Query History: Nonstationary Classification via Learned Retrieval*. ICLR Workshop on Time Series in the Age of Large Models, 2026. [\[paper\]](#)
- [4] S. Y. Arnob, Z. Su, M. Kim, O. Ostapenko, **R. Ohib**, E. Saleh, D. Precup, L. Caccia, A. Sordoni. *Exploring Sparse Adapters for Scalable Merging of Parameter Efficient Experts*. Conference on Language Modeling (COLM), 2025. [\[link\]](#)
- [5] S. Y. Arnob, **R. Ohib**, S. Plis, A. Zhang, A. Sordoni, D. Precup. *Efficient Reinforcement Learning by Discovering Neural Pathways*. Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2024. [\[link\]](#)
- [6] B. Thapaliya*, **R. Ohib***, E. Geenjaer, J. Liu, V. D. Calhoun, S. Plis. *Efficient Federated Learning on Distributed Neuroimaging Data*. Frontiers in Neuroinformatics, 2024. [\[link\]](#)
- [7] E. Geenjaer, D. Kim, **R. Ohib**, M. Duda, A. Kashyap, S. Plis, V. D. Calhoun. *Uncovering the Latent Dynamics of Whole-Brain fMRI Tasks with a Sequential Variational Autoencoder*. NeurIPS Deep Generative Models for Health Workshop, 2023. [\[link\]](#)
- [8] B. Thapaliya, **R. Ohib**, E. Geenjaer, J. Liu, V. D. Calhoun, S. Plis. *Decentralized Sparse Federated Learning for Efficient Training on Distributed Neuroimaging Data*. NeurIPS Medical Imaging Workshop, 2023. [\[link\]](#)
- [9] **R. Ohib**, B. Thapaliya, P. Gaggenapalli, J. Liu, V. D. Calhoun, S. Plis. *SalientGrads: Sparse Models for Communication Efficient and Data Aware Distributed Federated Training*. ICLR Sparsity in Neural Networks Workshop, 2023. [\[arXiv\]](#)
- [10] **R. Ohib**, N. Gillis, N. Dalmasso, S. Shah, V. Potluru, S. Plis. *Explicit Group Sparse Projection with Applications to Deep Learning and NMF*. Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR), 2022. [\[link\]](#)
- [11] S. Y. Arnob, **R. Ohib**, S. Plis, D. Precup. *Single-Shot Pruning for Offline Reinforcement Learning*. NeurIPS Offline Reinforcement Learning Workshop, 2021. [\[arXiv\]](#)
- [12] **R. Ohib**, N. Gillis, S. Shah, V. Potluru, S. Plis. *Grouped Sparse Projection for Deep Learning*. ICLR Hardware Aware Efficient Training Workshop, 2021. [\[link\]](#)
- [13] **R. Ohib**, S. Y. Arnob, M. Muhaisin, R. Arefin, T. Reza, M. R. Amin. *ENF Based Machine Learning Classification for Origin of Media Signals: Novel Features from Fourier Transform Profile*. International Conference on Electrical, Electronics and Computer Science (ICEECS), 2018.
- [14] S. Y. Arnob, **R. Ohib**, M. Muhaisin, T. B. Hassan. *Power File Extraction Process from Bangladesh Grid and Exploring ENF Based Classification Accuracy Using Machine Learning*. IEEE Region 10 Humanitarian Technology Conference (R10-HTC), 2017. [\[link\]](#)

HONORS AND AWARDS	2019	CIFAR and Amii travel grant, Deep Learning and Reinforcement Learning Summer School (DLRLSS), Edmonton, Canada
	2016	Honorable Mention and 11th place worldwide, IEEE Signal Processing Cup (team and programming lead)
	2013 – 2017	Undergraduate Honors List, IUT
	2013 – 2017	OIC Scholarship — full tuition waiver and monthly stipend for the duration of undergraduate study
TALKS AND PRESENTATIONS	Jul 2026	<i>The Hidden Structure of Deep Models: Discovering and Exploiting Sparse Subnetworks</i> , TReNDS Center, Atlanta, GA.
	Apr 2026	<i>What Models Learn and What They Hide: Sparse Structures and Representation Control</i> , Google DeepMind, Kirkland, WA.
	Apr 2026	<i>Navigating a PhD and Doing Scientific Research</i> , TReNDS Center, Atlanta, GA.
OPEN SOURCE	WeiGit	2022
	Weight versioning for neural networks facebookresearch/fairscale , Meta AI (FAIR)	
	• Version control and compression for model weights during training, exposed through a git-like command line and Python API; merged into the fairscale library.	
ACADEMIC SERVICE	2026	Program Committee , International Semantic Web Conference (ISWC)
	2023 – Present	Reviewer Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR) Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) IEEE Transactions on Neural Networks and Learning Systems (TNNLS)
GRADUATE COURSEWORK	• Statistical Machine Learning • Convex Optimization • Linear Algebra • Advanced Digital Signal Processing • Advanced Programming Techniques • Fourier Analysis • Information Processing in Neural Systems • Real Analysis	
PROGRAMMING	Languages	Python, C++, Matlab, Bash
	Frameworks	PyTorch, JAX, NumPy, Pandas
	Infrastructure	Linux, Slurm, distributed and multi-GPU training, cluster computing